

Ursa Major

The Mi'kmaq turn their eyes to the sky
And tell their children of a story
Begotten long ago:

*In the Spring, Ursa emerges
From her restful slumber;
She runs from star to star
Through the Summer,
Only to fall in the Autumn—
Flesh consumed by man
So he may regain life—
Spirit retreating to the den
She knows as home,
Renewing through the Winter
To rise again come March.*

Seven specks of light as
Seen through the soul's eyes
Become revelations of
Sacrifice,
Rebirth,
Eternal being.
We use bricks to build a house;
Other people to build a home;
Curiosity and faith to build a universe.

For what is the construction of worlds
If not the feat of a god?
With stories, Human and the Creator
Become one in the same—
We: the Shepherd,
Our children: the sheep.
A promise to Our gentle herd:
We will lead you by the right road.